

AI Uses Less Energy Than Raising a Whole Human Artist

Posted by u/Candid-Station-1235 • 0 points • 69 comments

The True Cost of Art (kWh and Dollars)

Let's break down the energy ledger, because honestly, the \$1.50 electricity bill for generating a thousand images on Stable Diffusion is starting to look like a bargain compared to, well, **me**.

* **The AI Artist:** *

* **Training:** Yes, training the models like Midjourney or Dall-E takes a massive amount of energy (think: a cross-country flight). But that cost is amortized across **millions** of users and **billions** of generations. It's a one-time *capital expenditure*.

* **Inference (Use):** Generating an image takes a few seconds on a GPU. The energy cost is often **less than a penny** per high-resolution piece.

* **Total:** Minimal per-piece energy cost.

The Human Artist: A Lifetime of Consumption

Now, let's look at the "Artist v1.0" system (a.k.a. a person). This isn't just about paint and pencils; it's about *existence*.

* **The Hardware (Body):** A human body is a 24/7 furnace. We require approximately **2,000 Calories (2.3 kWh)** of food energy *per day* just to stay alive. That's 840 kWh per year just for basic maintenance.

* **The Training (Education):** 18+ years of schooling, university art degrees, workshops, books, and access to equipment. Each year requires **heating/cooling classrooms**, transportation, and operating personal devices. This cost is astronomical.

* **The Supplies:** Paper, canvas, charcoal, brushes, software licenses, a powerful computer, a Wacom tablet, the electricity to run an apartment for a studio... you name it.

* **The Infrastructure:** Hospitals, roads, water treatment plants—the entire civic infrastructure needed to support a functioning, breathing, *art-making* citizen.

Conclusion

AI art might have a high initial training cost, but the marginal cost of producing a new piece is near zero. Raising a human artist is a commitment to **two decades of high-consumption**

living** before they even produce their first great work.

Comments

u/jwdvfx • 1 points • 2025-11-17 10:21 UTC

Who would had thought slop is cheaper ?

u/babooshka9302920 • 1 points • 2025-11-17 07:21 UTC

only reading posts a human wrote sorry

u/Candid-Station-1235 • 1 points • 2025-11-17 07:28 UTC

typical ignorance of the fool

u/babooshka9302920 • 1 points • 2025-11-17 07:30 UTC

r u flirting with me